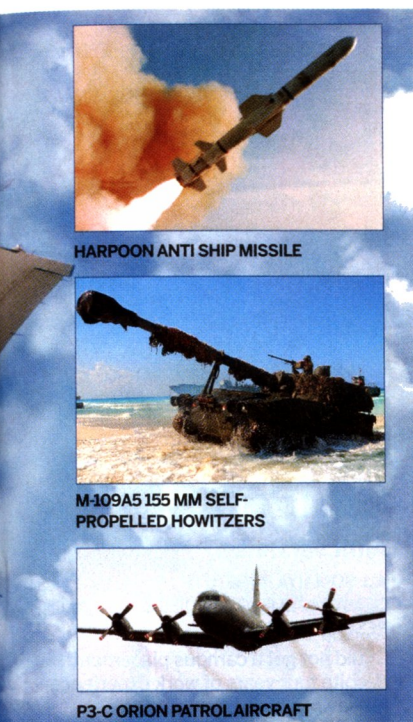




BOOTY AND THE EAST

Most US weapons supplied to Pakistan have little utility against the Taliban and are India-centric

Weapon System	Utility against Taliban
P-3C Orion aircraft Long range maritime patrol and strike aircraft	☐ Yes ☒ No ☐ May be
F-16 fighter Multi-role air superiority fighter and bomber. 32 new aircraft with contract to upgrade 40	☐ Yes ☒ No ☐ Maybe
TOW anti-tank missile Helicopter and armoured vehicle launched anti-tank missile	☐ Yes ☐ No ☒ Maybe
Harpoon anti-ship missile Air and submarine launched anti-ship missile with 120 km range	☐ Yes ☒ No ☐ Maybe
155 mm self-propelled gun For use against massed infantry, enemy fortifications and vehicles	☐ Yes ☐ No ☒ Maybe

from north-western Pakistan, the so-called 'crucible of terrorism'. "We are concerned by the build-up in Pakistan's capabilities with arms ostensibly meant to fight an insurgency, and have conveyed this to the US at various levels in the past," says a senior Indian Defence Ministry official. As SIPRI notes, the volume of deliveries to Pakistan has increased significantly in recent years with 41 per cent of all transfers taking place last year alone.

Between 2004 and last year, 40 per cent of Pakistan's imports of major conventional weapons came from the US. "The US now accounts for one-fourth of the conventional weapons exported to Pakistan," says Paul Holtom of SIPRI. Annual US military aid to Pakistan is currently around \$300 million (Rs 1,480 crore) a year which could triple if the Kerry-Lugar Bill goes through. Counter-insurgency, admittedly an area the Pakistan Army has little or no expertise in, calls for huge investments in training, transport helicopters and infantry

weapons, which has not happened so far. "There is no congruence between the US objectives in South Asia and the nature of weapons and systems which Pakistan is being supplied so far," says Thomas Mathew, deputy director, Institute of Defence Studies and Analyses. In fact, the weapons have had the opposite effect. "US military aid has always emboldened the Pakistan Army and ISI to wage asymmetric warfare against India and the

terror attacks in Mumbai were part of the same continuum," says Brigadier Gurmeet Kanwal of the Centre for Land Warfare Studies.

Pakistan has traditionally used the canard of a danger on its western border to seek arms which are instead used on its eastern front. Following the Soviet invasion of Afghanistan, Pakistan's military dictator General Zia-ul-Haq pressured the US and successfully obtained the F-16 fighter aircraft (later rejigged to carry nuclear weapons). It waged a proxy war against India by diverting to Kashmir the arms gifted by the CIA to the ISI to fight the Soviet invaders in Afghanistan. The Obama administration has placed conditions on military aid, with President Obama asking Pakistan to get rid of its 'India obsession'. But according to Indian military analysts, it will be impossible to monitor the deployment of weapons the US supplies to Pakistan for its War on Terror Part II. "Since field inspections are not possible, the US will have to rely on annual statements from Pakistan about where the weapons have been deployed," says Kanwal.

Despite probing questions raised by the US Congress in the past, the US administration has managed to get the aid through. Last year, for instance, the US government managed to clear a \$200-million upgrade in the targeting abilities of F-16s, ostensibly to mount precision attacks on the Taliban, despite objections from the Congress. Pakistan cited bankruptcy to get the US to pay for the upgrade. "The US administration must realise that the Pakistan Army and the ISI are part of the problem and cannot, therefore, be part of the solution," says Kanwal. In *Deception*, an investigative book which details A.Q. Khan's nuclear blackmarketeering allegedly with the connivance of the Pakistan army, a Musharraf aide gleefully informs the authors about being let off by President Bush: "We were back in the old relationship, you know, the one where we do as we please and they do as we please." ■